Long Light

Nº 14 · WINTER 2026 · PHOTOGRAPHS MADE AT THE EDGES OF THE DAY

The net mender of Cangas · A forest that keeps its fog · Four hundred
kilometres of road and one bend

EDITORIAL

The hour before

Every photograph in this issue was made in the first or the last hour of daylight, when the sun is low enough to throw a shadow longer than the thing that casts it.Photographers callitthe goldenhour,though half of it is blue. We asked four contributors to go out in it and bring back one picture each, and to tell us what they were doing there.
What came back is a quiet issue. A man mending a net he has mended for fifty years. A forest that holds its fog until ten in the morning. A road that

runs straight for so long that the one bend in it has a name. And on the cover, a walker on a salt flat who did not know he was being photographed, and who kept walking until he was a dot against the dusk. We have printed this issue on a matte paper with a soft-touch coat, and laid a gloss varnish over the photographs alone. Turn the page under a lamp and the pictures catch the light while the page around them stays dark and still. It is the closest a magazine can come to a print on a wall.

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PORTRAIT · CANGAS, GALICIA

The net mender
Manuel Lires has mended nets on the same stretch

of the quay at Cangas since he was fourteen. He is sixty-six now, and the boats he mends for belong to the grandsons of the men who first paid him. He starts at six, before the light, and works by feel until the sun comes over the hill behind the town and he can see the knots.

The net in the photograph is a trawl, forty metres of orangepolyethylene that cameback fromthebank with a tear the length of a man. He finds the edge of the damage, cuts it square, and knits in new mesh

with a wooden needle that his father carved. A good mender, he says, can tell from the tension of the twine whether the net was torn on rock or by a fish. Our photographer spent three mornings on the quay before Manuel stopped looking up. The picture was made on the third, in the ten minutes when the sun was low enough to light the net from behind and turn it into something that glowed. He did not look at it until we sent him a print. He said the knots were right.

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LANDSCAPE · IRATI, NAVARRE

A forest that keeps its fog
The beech and pine forest of Irati sits in a bowl of the
western Pyrenees, and on still autumn mornings it
fills with fog like water in a basin. The fog stays until
the sun is high enough to reach over the rim, which
in November is after ten. Until then the forest is grey
and close, and sound does not carry.
Our photographer walked in at seven with a tripod and a flask and waited by a stand of pines where a

gap in the canopy faces east. At twenty past nine a beam came through the gap and lay across the fog for four minutes. She made eleven frames and kept one. The picture is about the waiting, she says. The beam lasted four minutes, but the forest had been getting ready for it all morning.

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TRAVEL · UTAH

The bend
For four hundred kilometres the road south of Moab runs nearly straight, and the drivers who know it give names to the few places where it does not. The bend in this photograph is called the Elbow, though it turns by no more than a few degrees. Coming at it from the north at dusk, with the mesas lit red on either side, it is the first thing in an hour that the eye can hold on to.

Our contributor drove the road three times in one week, each time leaving later, until the light fell where he wanted it: across the asphalt, so that the centre line burned yellow and the verges went to shadow. He stood in the middle of the road to make the picture. Nothing came in either direction for twenty minutes.

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